

ENG505 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 01 to 05

(ENG505) Language Learning Theories

Lesson-01

INTRODUCTION TO THE COURSE-I

Topic-001: Introduction to the Course Learning Theories

What is the main focus of this course?

The course provides an in-depth understanding of language learning theories

What are the aims of the course?

The aims of the course are: to develop awareness of teaching approaches supported by theories, enable effective planning and teaching, and analyze current research trends.

What is the main focus of this course?

The main focus of this course is to provide students with an in-depth understanding of language learning theories. The emphasis is on six key theories and their theoretical and pedagogical aspects related to language learning. Additionally, the course incorporates current research trends in the field of language learning theories to equip students with a comprehensive awareness of these concepts and their diverse implementations.

What are the aims of this course?

The course aims to achieve several goals, including the development of an awareness of current teaching approaches and methodologies that are supported by language learning theories. It also aims to enable effective planning and teaching by providing a solid rationale based on these theories. Furthermore, the course seeks to facilitate the analysis of current research trends in the realm of language learning.

Topic-002: Introduction to Language Learning

How is language defined?

Language is defined as a systematic means of communication using symbols with conventionalized meanings, used for communication within a speech community.

According to Pinker, what are the characteristics of language acquisition?

Pinker states that language acquisition is spontaneous, unconscious, and distinct from general cognitive abilities.

How can language be defined?

Language can be defined as a systematic means of communication that employs conventionalized signs, sounds, gestures, or marks to convey ideas or feelings with understood meanings. It is a complex and kaleidoscopic phenomenon that involves linguistic units with unique systems.

According to Pinker, what are the characteristics of language acquisition?

Pinker asserts that language acquisition is a specialized skill that develops spontaneously in children without conscious effort or formal instruction. It operates without conscious awareness of its underlying logic and is distinct from general abilities to process information. Pinker's view emphasizes the universality of language acquisition and its consistency across individuals.

Topic-003: Historical Perspective-I Part-I

What philosophical aspect is important for understanding language learning?

The philosophical aspect of language learning is concerned with the nature of knowledge, reality, and attitudes.

What was the nature vs. nurture debate in language acquisition?

Plato supported nature, believing knowledge was innate, while Locke proposed tabula rasa, where knowledge comes from sensory experience.

How do Plato and Aristotle contribute to the philosophical aspect of language learning?

Plato and Aristotle's contributions revolve around the relationship between language and knowledge. They engaged in the nature vs. nurture debate, with Plato leaning towards the idea that knowledge is innate, while Aristotle explored the role of experience and external factors in knowledge acquisition. This debate laid the groundwork for understanding the interplay between nature and nurture in language learning.

What is the nature vs. nurture debate in language acquisition?

The nature vs. nurture debate involves the question of whether language knowledge is innate (nature) or acquired through experience and external influences (nurture). Plato and other proponents of nature argue for innate knowledge, while Locke's concept of tabula rasa suggests that knowledge is acquired through sensory experience, emphasizing the role of nurture.

Topic-004: Historical Perspective-I Part-II

What did B.F. Skinner's behaviorism emphasize?

Skinner's behaviorism claimed that behavior is a response to external stimuli, rejecting the concept of an innate language device.

How did John Schumann's "Acculturation Model" relate to language learning?

A8: Schumann's model covers social and psychological aspects of language learning, particularly in immigrant contexts.

What is the essence of B.F. Skinner's behaviorism in language learning?

B.F. Skinner's behaviorism asserts that language learning is a result of conditioned behaviors, driven by external stimuli and reinforced by corrective feedback. Skinner's perspective contrasts with the notion of an innate Language Acquisition Device proposed by Noam Chomsky.

How does John Schumann's Acculturation Model contribute to language learning?

John Schumann's Acculturation Model introduces a social perspective on language learning, particularly in the context of immigrants. The model suggests that language learning is facilitated by immersion in the target language culture, considering external factors and social forces as integral to the process.

Topic-005: Historical Perspective-II

What is the main focus of the Behaviorism approach?

Behaviorism emphasizes observable behaviors as learning outcomes.

How does Constructivism view learning?

Constructivism emphasizes that individuals construct knowledge through mental processes and understanding.

What is the core focus of Behaviorism in language learning?

Behaviorism emphasizes observable behaviors as the primary outcomes of learning. It views learning as a result of responses to external stimuli and focuses on shaping desired behaviors through reinforcement.

How does Constructivism approach the process of learning?

Constructivism highlights the role of mental processes and understanding in learning. It asserts that individuals actively construct knowledge based on their experiences and interactions with their environment, rather than passively absorbing information.

Topic-006: Introduction to the Key Theories Part-I

What is the central idea of the Behaviorist Theory?

The Behaviorist Theory sees language learning as a set of conditioned behaviors in response to stimuli.

According to Universal Grammar Theory, what is Language Acquisition Device (LAD)?

Universal Grammar Theory proposes that children have an innate Language Acquisition Device to learn language.

What does Krashen's Input Hypothesis suggest?

Krashen's Input Hypothesis claims that speaking fluency develops over time through exposure to language beyond current comprehension.

What is the central premise of the Behaviorist Theory?

The Behaviorist Theory posits that language learning is a set of conditioned behaviors in response to stimuli. It emphasizes the role of corrective feedback in shaping language habits.

What is Universal Grammar (UG) Theory?

Universal Grammar Theory suggests that humans are born with a Language Acquisition Device (LAD) that enables them to acquire language naturally. It emphasizes the presence of language universals and parameters that govern language variation.

What does Krashen's Input Hypothesis propose?

Krashen's Input Hypothesis states that language acquisition occurs subconsciously through exposure to comprehensible input beyond one's current level of comprehension. It distinguishes between acquisition (subconscious) and learning (conscious).

Topic-007: Introduction to the Key Theories Part-II

What does Cognitive Theory focus on in language learning?

Cognitive Theory emphasizes internal mental processes and learning through analysis, feedback, and practice.

How does Conversation Theory view language learning?

Conversation Theory emphasizes learning through participation, scaffolding, corrective feedback, and meaningful communication.

What is the basis of Schumann's Acculturation Theory?

Schumann's theory is based on social factors and culture affecting language learning, including attitudes and stereotypes.

How does Cognitive Theory contribute to language learning?

Cognitive Theory emphasizes internal mental processes in language learning. Proficiency is believed to develop through practice and automaticity, with positive and negative feedback playing crucial roles in reconstructing meaningful language learning.

What is the basis of Conversation Theory in language learning?

Conversation Theory underscores participation and communication as vital mechanisms for language learning. It emphasizes scaffolding, corrective feedback, and meaningful interaction as key components of effective language learning.

How does Schumann's Acculturation Theory view language learning?

Schumann's Acculturation Theory emphasizes social forces and external factors in language learning. It considers the target language culture, attitudes, and stereotypes as influential in the acquisition process, and highlights the role of errors and correction.

Lesson-02

INTRODUCTION TO THE COURSE-II

Topic 008: Introduction to Approaches, Methods and Techniques Part-I

What is Edward Anthony's three-level framework based on?

Edward Anthony's three-level framework is based on 'Approach, Methods, and Techniques.'

Define 'Approach' in Anthony's framework.

Answer: 'Approach' in Anthony's framework refers to a set of principles or ideas about the nature of language learning.

How does 'Method' differ from 'Approach'?

Answer: 'Method' is an overall mechanism for language teaching, while 'Approach' is a broader set of principles about language learning.

According to Repka and Stern, what does 'method or methodology' cover?

Answer: According to Repka and Stern, 'method or methodology' is a broader term that encompasses the rest.

Explain Edward Anthony's three-level framework and its components.

Answer: Edward Anthony's three-level framework, proposed in 1965, outlines the concepts of 'Approach, Methods, and Techniques' in language teaching. The 'Approach' refers to a set of underlying principles and beliefs about the nature of language learning. It lays the foundation for teaching methods and techniques. The 'Method' encompasses the overall strategy and instructional plan used in language teaching, often guided by the underlying approach. 'Techniques' are specific strategies and activities that teachers employ to achieve the goals of a particular method. Researchers have different perspectives on these terms. Anthony emphasized the importance of the approach, while other scholars like Richards and Rogers considered the term 'method' to be broader than 'approach.' Repka and Stern extended this concept, claiming that 'method or methodology' is an umbrella term encompassing all the levels. In essence, this framework aids educators in structuring effective language teaching strategies by understanding the relationship between these components.

Topic 009: Introduction to Approaches, Methods and Techniques Part-II

What are the three principal views of language discussed?

Answer: The three principal views of language are structural, functional, and interactive.

What is the focus of the structural view of language?

Answer: The structural view of language focuses on understanding structurally related elements in a language.

Name the two methods associated with the structural view.

Answer: The grammar translation method and the audio-lingual method are associated with the structural view.

How does the functional view define language?

Answer: The functional view defines language as a tool to accomplish certain functions.

Compare and contrast the structural, functional, and interactive views of language teaching.

Answer: The three principal views of language teaching are structural, functional, and interactive. The 'Structural' view focuses on understanding language's underlying structure, including grammar and vocabulary. Methods like the grammar translation method and the audio-lingual method belong to this view, emphasizing memorization of grammar rules and habit formation through repetition. The 'Functional' view considers language as a tool to accomplish various functions, emphasizing communication in real-life contexts. Methods following this view, such as situational language teaching, prioritize oral skills and practical language use. The 'Interactive' view sees language as a means of creating social connections, highlighting interaction and meaningful communication. Methods within this view, like the Direct Method, Communicative Language Teaching, and Total Physical Response, stress the importance of authentic communication and interaction for language learning. Each view offers a distinct perspective on language teaching, catering to different aspects of language acquisition.

Topic 010: Interactive Method

How does the interactive view of language see language?

Answer: The interactive view of language sees language as a means of creating and maintaining social relations.

What is the key emphasis of the Direct Method?

Answer: The Direct Method emphasizes learning the target language through imitation.

What is the central focus of Communicative Language Teaching?

Answer: The central focus of Communicative Language Teaching is interaction as both the means and the ultimate goal.

What does Total Physical Response emphasize?

Answer: Total Physical Response emphasizes instant understanding of the target language through responding to commands.

Explain the key features of the Interactive view of language teaching and its associated methods.

Answer: The Interactive view of language teaching regards language as a tool for building and maintaining social relations. This perspective emphasizes meaningful interaction and communication. Within this view, various methods emphasize different aspects of interactive learning.

- The 'Direct Method' emphasizes learning through target language imitation, avoiding translation and using real-life situations.
- 'Communicative Language Teaching' prioritizes communication as both a means and goal of language learning. Learners engage in interactive tasks and use language in authentic contexts.
- 'Community Language Learning' centers around learners as members of a community. It promotes mutual trust between teacher and learner, fostering a supportive environment.
- The 'Silent Way' encourages learners to solve problems and construct understanding using the target language. It involves the teacher's minimal use of speech.
- 'Suggestopedia' creates a rich sensory learning environment with music, color, and active participation to lower learners' affective filters.
- 'Total Physical Response' emphasizes understanding through physical responses to commands in the target language.

These methods align with the Interactive view by prioritizing interaction, authentic communication, and engaging learning experiences to develop language skills.

Topic 011: Introduction to Approaches, Methods, and Techniques Part-III **According to Brown's taxonomy, what are the three types of techniques?**

Answer: According to Brown's taxonomy, the three types of techniques are controlled, semi-controlled, and free techniques.

How does 'Activity' differ from 'Procedure'?

Answer: 'Activity' deals with the learner's performance, while 'Procedure' deals with practices and behaviors in teaching.

Differentiate between 'Technique,' 'Activity,' and 'Procedure' in language teaching.

Answer: In the realm of language teaching, understanding the distinctions between 'Technique,' 'Activity,' and 'Procedure' is crucial.

- A 'Technique' refers to a specific strategy or approach employed to achieve a particular teaching objective. Brown's taxonomy categorizes techniques

as controlled, semi-controlled, and free, based on the degree of learner autonomy. Controlled techniques involve guided practice, semi-controlled techniques offer a balance between guidance and independence, and free techniques encourage open expression.

- An 'Activity' refers to a task or exercise that engages learners in a particular language-related task. Activities can vary in complexity and purpose, such as role-playing, group discussions, or writing exercises. They are designed to enhance specific language skills and cater to different learning styles.
- A 'Procedure' outlines the steps and sequence followed in a lesson or instructional session. It encompasses the teacher's actions and decisions, including introducing the topic, explaining activities, monitoring student progress, and providing feedback. Effective procedures contribute to a well-structured and organized learning experience.

In summary, techniques are overarching strategies, activities are specific tasks, and procedures are the sequences followed in the teaching process. Each plays a distinct role in creating an effective and engaging language learning environment.

Lesson-03

INTRODUCTION TO KEY CONCEPTS IN LANGUAGE LEARNING

Topic-012: Acquisition vs. Learning

What is the main difference between acquisition and learning in language development?

Answer: Acquisition refers to the unconscious process of gaining language skills, while learning involves conscious effort and practice.

How does the Mentalist Approach view language acquisition?

Answer: The Mentalist Approach sees acquisition as an effortless, subconscious process in which children assimilate linguistic knowledge.

What is the Language Acquisition Device (LAD)?

Answer: The LAD is an inherited ability mentioned in the Mentalist Approach that enables children to acquire grammar.

What are the key features of language acquisition according to the Mentalist Approach?

Answer:

- Presence of Language Acquisition Device (LAD)
- Children being "hard-wired" to acquire grammar
- Lack of evidence of grammatical errors in children
- Awareness of grammaticality in sentences

How does the Behaviorist Approach define learning in language development?

Answer: The Behaviorist Approach views learning as a mechanical process involving conscious modification of knowledge through repetition and habit formation.

What are the basic elements of learning according to the Behaviorist Approach?

Answer: Drill, imitation, and repetition are the fundamental elements of learning according to the Behaviorist Approach.

How does learning differ from acquisition in terms of conscious awareness?

Answer: Learning involves both explicit (conscious) and implicit (unconscious) processes, whereas acquisition is largely unconscious.

What role does practice play in language learning according to the Behaviorist Approach?

Answer: Language learning is practice-based, involving imitation, repetition, reinforcement, and retention.

What is the difference between acquisition and learning in language development?

Acquisition and learning are two distinct approaches in language development. Acquisition refers to the subconscious process where children unconsciously gain linguistic knowledge, while learning involves conscious effort and practice. Acquisition is akin to effortlessly absorbing one's native language during childhood, while learning entails conscious study and application of language rules.

How does the Mentalist Approach explain language acquisition?

The Mentalist Approach views acquisition as an innate, subconscious process through which children naturally acquire their native language. This approach

emphasizes that acquisition is not dependent on intelligence but rather a universal process that all children go through. It highlights the concept of a Language Acquisition Device (LAD), an inherited ability that enables children to grasp grammar rules without explicit instruction.

What are the key features of language acquisition according to the Mentalist Approach?

Long Answer: Language acquisition, under the Mentalist Approach, is characterized by several features:

- Presence of the Language Acquisition Device (LAD), an inherited ability facilitating grammar acquisition.
- Children are inherently predisposed to acquire grammar.
- The absence of significant evidence of grammatical errors in children's language production.
- Children possess an awareness of grammatical correctness in language.
- It generates the ability to discern grammaticality or ungrammaticality in sentences.

How does the Behaviorist Approach define learning in language development?

Answer: The Behaviorist Approach views learning as a conscious process involving habit formation and mechanical repetition. Unlike acquisition, which is subconscious, learning requires deliberate effort and practice to modify one's linguistic knowledge. In this approach, learning involves both explicit awareness of the process and implicit changes in the learner's knowledge base.

What are the fundamental elements of learning according to the Behaviorist Approach?

Answer: In the context of the Behaviorist Approach, learning encompasses key elements such as:

Drill: Repeated practice of language components for reinforcement.

Imitation: Copying language patterns and structures.

Repetition: Reiterating language forms for memorization and mastery.

Topic-013: Competence vs. Performance

What is competence in language and who coined this term?

Answer: Competence refers to the 'mental reality' of language, characterized by linguistic rules and the ability to generate infinite sentences. The term was used by Chomsky.

How is competence related to the concepts of Langue and Parole by Saussure?

Competence is similar to Langue, representing unconscious knowledge of grammar, while Parole corresponds to performance in concrete situations.

How does Chomsky describe performance in language use?

Answer: Performance is the actual use of language in specific situations, considering factors like linguistic competence, context, memory, and more.

Why might performance contain errors despite linguistic competence?

Answer: Performance is influenced by various factors beyond linguistic competence, such as individual style, dialectical environment, health, and emotions, which can lead to errors.

How does competence differ from performance in the context of language?

In the realm of linguistics, competence and performance are distinct concepts. Competence refers to the inherent, underlying knowledge of grammar rules and structures, allowing individuals to generate a potentially infinite number of sentences. Performance, on the other hand, pertains to the actual use of language in real-life situations, which can be influenced by various factors beyond linguistic knowledge.

What are the key features of linguistic competence?

Answer: Linguistic competence is characterized by several notable features:

- Similarity to Saussure's concepts of Langue and Parole.
- Unconscious understanding of grammar rules.
- Implicit knowledge of language structure.
- Comparison to Chomsky's concept of the "ideal" speaker-hearer's language knowledge.
- Possibility of measuring and assessing competence.

How does Chomsky differentiate between competence and performance?

Answer: Chomsky's differentiation between competence and performance is based on the distinction between an individual's underlying linguistic knowledge and their actual use of language. Competence refers to the innate understanding of grammar rules and structures, akin to Langue. Performance involves the practical application

of language in specific situations, influenced by factors such as context, memory, and individual style.

Topic-014: Deductive vs. Inductive Learning

What is the main distinction between deductive and inductive learning approaches?

Answer: Deductive learning involves teaching rules followed by examples, while inductive learning starts with examples and leads to the determination of rules.

What kind of learners is deductive learning suitable for?

Answer: Deductive learning is suitable for learners who need a clear foundation and are accustomed to a more traditional approach.

What is the key feature of inductive learning?

Answer: Inductive learning focuses on learners discovering rules through examples, encouraging active involvement in the learning process.

How does inductive learning encourage learners to understand concepts?

Answer: Inductive learning enables learners to "notice" how concepts work by analyzing examples and deducing relevant rules.

What sets deductive learning apart from inductive learning?

Deductive learning and inductive learning are two contrasting approaches to language instruction.

- Deductive learning is teacher-centered and involves presenting learners with rules followed by examples and practice. This approach is suitable for learners who require a clear foundation to start learning a new language item and are accustomed to a traditional teaching approach.
- Inductive learning, in contrast, is learner-centered and begins with examples. Learners are tasked with deducing the relevant rules based on the examples provided. This approach emphasizes active engagement and understanding of concepts through observation and deduction.

How does inductive learning benefit language learners?

Long Answer: Inductive learning offers several advantages to language learners:

- Learners actively engage in the learning process.
- Through examples, learners "notice" how language concepts work in real contexts.
- Encourages critical thinking and deduction skills.

- Fosters a deeper understanding of language structures and patterns.
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Lesson-04

BEHAVIOURISM-I

Topic: Behaviorism (015)

Who initiated the behaviorist movement and in what year did it begin?

John Watson in 1913.

What is the key emphasis of the behaviorist approach in psychology?

Scientific and objective methods of investigation.

According to behaviorists, how is knowledge acquired and how do humans start?

Knowledge is acquired externally, and humans are born with a blank slate.

How does learning occur according to behaviorists, and what results from this process?

Learning occurs through association between stimuli and response processes, leading to the formation of specific habits.

What is a common criticism of behaviorism in terms of learners' abilities?

Critics argue that behaviorism does not provide learners with problem-solving skills and opportunities for improvement.

Name some examples of behaviorist theories.

Drill/rote work, repetitive practice, bonus points, participation points, verbal reinforcement, establishing rules.

Who initiated the behaviorist movement and when did it begin?

The behaviorist movement began with John Watson in 1913. He emphasized scientific and objective methods of investigation in psychology.

What is the core premise of the behaviorist approach to learning?

According to behaviorists, knowledge is acquired through external stimuli, and humans are born with a blank slate. Learning occurs through associations between stimuli and responses, leading to the formation of specific habits.

How does behaviorism view the acquisition of knowledge and the role of consciousness?

Behaviorism asserts that knowledge is externally obtained, and consciousness is not considered a significant factor in learning. It focuses on observable behaviors and objective measurements.

What are some criticisms of behaviorism in terms of its impact on learners' skills?

Critics argue that behaviorism fails to provide learners with problem-solving abilities and opportunities for creative thinking. It may lead to rote memorization rather than deep understanding.

Topic: Pavlovian Conditioning (016)

Who is the founder of Pavlovian Conditioning, and when did he discover it?

Ivan Pavlov, discovered it accidentally during the 1890s.

Describe the process of Pavlovian Conditioning using terms: Unconditioned Stimulus, Unconditioned Response.

Unconditioned Stimulus (food) leads to Unconditioned Response (salivation).

What is the Law of Temporal Contiguity in Pavlovian Conditioning?

It states that two stimuli presented together in time can develop an association.

What is the primary factor affecting the strength of association in Pavlovian Conditioning?

Temporal congruity, or the closeness in time between the conditioned stimulus (CS) and unconditioned stimulus (US).

List some key features of Pavlovian conditioning.

Stimulus, Response, Unconditioned Stimulus, Conditioned Stimulus, Conditioned Response, Extinction, Spontaneous Recovery, Generalization, Discrimination.

Who is the founder of Pavlovian Conditioning, and how did he accidentally discover it?

Ivan Pavlov, a Russian physiologist, accidentally discovered Pavlovian Conditioning in the 1890s while conducting an experiment on dogs. He observed that dogs salivated at the sound of a bell associated with food.

Explain the process of Pavlovian Conditioning using the terms Unconditioned Stimulus and Unconditioned Response.

In Pavlovian Conditioning, an unconditioned stimulus (US), such as food, triggers an unconditioned response (UR), like salivation. Over time, a conditioned

stimulus (CS), like a bell, becomes associated with the US, leading to a conditioned response (CR), where the bell alone causes salivation.

How does the Law of Temporal Contiguity relate to Pavlovian Conditioning?

The Law of Temporal Contiguity states that when two stimuli are presented closely in time, an association may form between them. This is essential for establishing a strong connection between the conditioned stimulus (CS) and the unconditioned stimulus (US) in conditioning.

What factors influence the strength of association in Pavlovian Conditioning?

The strength of association between the CS and US in Pavlovian Conditioning is largely affected by the closeness in time (temporal congruity) between the two stimuli.

Topic: Classical Conditioning (017)

How did John Watson build upon Pavlov's ideas?

He developed the concept of classical conditioning based on Pavlov's observations.

What does the theory of classical conditioning support in terms of learning?

It supports the idea that habit formation occurs and opposes the notion of consciousness as a primary factor in learning.

What are the three stages of classical conditioning?

Before, During, and After Conditioning.

How did John Watson build upon Pavlov's ideas in the context of learning?

John Watson extended Pavlov's observations to propose classical conditioning as a process of learning. He emphasized that neutral stimuli could become conditioned, leading to specific responses without the involvement of consciousness.

Explain the stages of classical conditioning and their significance.

Classical conditioning involves three stages: Before Conditioning, During Conditioning, and After Conditioning. These stages represent the process of learning through association between stimuli and responses, ultimately leading to the development of conditioned responses.

Topic: Reciprocal Determinism (018)

Who introduced the concept of Reciprocal Determinism, and in what year?

Albert Bandura in 1977.

According to Bandura's Social Learning Theory, what factors contribute to behavior?

Behavior is the result of the interaction between cognitive, behavioral, and environmental determinants.

Explain what mediating processes are in the context of Reciprocal Determinism.

Mediating processes occur between stimuli and responses.

How does observational learning contribute to behavior according to Bandura?

Behavior is learned from the environment through the process of observational learning.

What role does reinforcement or punishment play in determining behavior?

Reinforcement or punishment determines behavior.

How does Bandura suggest that humans learn most of their behavior?

By observing the behavior of others (models) and using that information as a guide for their own behavior.

Who introduced the concept of Reciprocal Determinism, and what is its main premise?

Albert Bandura introduced the concept of Reciprocal Determinism in 1977. This idea emphasizes that behavior is shaped by the interaction between cognitive, behavioral, and environmental factors.

How does Bandura's Social Learning Theory differ from strict behaviorism?

Bandura's theory expands on behaviorism by considering both external and internal factors in learning. It highlights the importance of mediating processes and observational learning in shaping behavior.

What is observational learning, and how does it relate to Bandura's theory?

Observational learning is the process of acquiring new behaviors by observing others. According to Bandura, humans learn by observing models' behavior, imitating it, and using reinforcement or punishment to determine their own behavior.

What are mediating processes, and why are they significant in Bandura's theory?

Mediating processes are cognitive mechanisms that intervene between stimuli and responses. They play a crucial role in how individuals interpret and process information from their environment, influencing their behavior.

Lesson-05

BEHAVIOURISM-II

Topic-019: Operant Conditioning

What is Operant Conditioning?

Operant Conditioning is a concept proposed by B.F. Skinner where behavior is influenced by consequences.

What is Verbal Behavior according to Skinner?

Skinner introduced the theory of Verbal Behavior in 1957, suggesting that a person's behavior is reinforced through the mediation of others.

What are the three types of responses Skinner identified?

- Neutral Operant
- Reinforcer
- Punisher

How does reinforcement affect behavior according to Skinner?

Positive and negative reinforcement lead to the development of specific behaviors.

How is punishment linked to negative reinforcement?

Punishment is closely related to negative reinforcement, where the scheduling of reinforcement determines behavior modification.

What is Operant Conditioning and who introduced this concept?

Operant Conditioning is a theory proposed by B.F. Skinner. It suggests that behaviors are influenced by their consequences. Skinner believed that behaviors leading to positive outcomes are likely to be repeated, while those with negative outcomes are less likely to be repeated.

Describe the three types of responses identified by Skinner that can follow behavior.

Skinner identified three types of responses:

- **Neutral Operant:** These are responses that have no significant impact on behavior.
- **Reinforcer:** These are responses that strengthen or increase the likelihood of a behavior being repeated.
- **Punisher:** These are responses that weaken or decrease the likelihood of a behavior being repeated.

How does reinforcement affect behavior according to Skinner?

Positive and negative reinforcement affect behavior. Positive reinforcement involves providing rewards for desired behaviors, leading to their repetition. Negative reinforcement involves removing or avoiding unpleasant stimuli when a desired behavior is performed, also promoting the behavior's repetition.

Explain the relationship between punishment and negative reinforcement.

Punishment involves introducing negative consequences to reduce the likelihood of a behavior being repeated. Negative reinforcement, on the other hand, involves removing negative stimuli to encourage a behavior's repetition. Both punishment and negative reinforcement influence behavior through consequences.

How does scheduling of reinforcement impact behavior modification?

The scheduling of reinforcement determines when and how often reinforcement is provided for a behavior. Different schedules, like fixed ratio or variable interval, can impact the rate and pattern of behavior modification. For example, a fixed ratio schedule rewards after a specific number of responses, while a variable interval schedule rewards after varying time intervals.

Topic-020: Mediation Theory

Who introduced the Mediation Theory?

Charles Osgood introduced the Mediation Theory in 1953 and 1957.

What does the Mediation Theory propose about linguistic stimuli?

Linguistic stimuli elicit a mediating response that is self-stimulating, acting within the learner.

What are the features of the Mediation Theory?

- Physical stimulus
- Internal response
- Internal stimulus
- Outward response

How does the theory function at different levels?

- **Sensational Level:** Basic stimulus-response reaction.
- **Perception Level:** Relating input to past experiences.
- **Representational Level:** Overt behavioral response to the stimulus.

What is the Mediation Theory and who introduced it?

The Mediation Theory was introduced by Charles Osgood. This theory posits that linguistic stimuli evoke a mediating response within the learner. This cognitive process bridges internal and external processes, facilitating the development of behavioral associations.

Outline the features of the Mediation Theory.

- The Mediation Theory's features include:
- **Physical stimulus:** External input (e.g., sensory perceptions).
- **Internal response:** Internalization of the stimulus.
- **Internal stimulus:** Thought process connecting stimulus to response.
- **Outward response:** Observable behavioral reaction.

How does the Mediation Theory function at different levels?

The Mediation Theory operates at three levels:

- **Sensational Level:** Basic stimulus-response reactions occur.
- **Perception Level:** Input is linked to past experiences.
- **Representational Level:** Overt behavioral responses are triggered by the word or stimulus.

Topic-021: The Law of Effect

Who introduced the Law of Effect?

Edward Thorndike introduced the Law of Effect in 1898.

What does the Law of Effect state?

The Law of Effect proposes that pleasant feedback leads to behavior repetition, while unpleasant feedback stops it.

What are the three laws of learning proposed by Thorndike?

- Law of Readiness
- Law of Exercise (law of use and law of disuse)
- Law of Effect

What are the five characteristics of learning supplemented by Thorndike?

- Multiple or varied response

- Set of behaviors or attitude
- Partial activity or prepotency of elements
- Assimilation
- Associative shifting

What is the Law of Effect and who introduced it?

The Law of Effect was introduced by Edward Thorndike. It posits that behaviors leading to pleasant outcomes are more likely to be repeated, while those associated with unpleasant outcomes are less likely to be repeated.

Describe the three laws of learning proposed by Thorndike.

Thorndike's three laws of learning are:

- **Law of Readiness:** Willingness and readiness are important for effective learning.
- **Law of Exercise:** Learning is enhanced through practice (law of use) and weakened through lack of practice (law of disuse).
- **Law of Effect:** Pleasant outcomes strengthen behavior connections, while unpleasant outcomes weaken them.

What are the five characteristics of learning supplementary to Thorndike's laws?

The supplementary characteristics are:

- **Multiple or varied response:** Diverse ways to respond to a situation.
- **Set of behaviors or attitude:** Complex behaviors are often learned as a unit.
- **Partial activity or prepotency of elements:** Some aspects of behavior might take precedence in certain situations.
- **Assimilation:** Incorporating new information into existing mental frameworks.
- **Associative shifting:** Adjusting behavior associations based on changing circumstances.

Working on the Next Lessons